

Mataupu 14 | Tāhaoga a te Fenua

A te mata o muna tenei, e fakamatala i ai a ni tāhaoga mo faiga fakafiafiaga ni fakafiafia ki ai a kautama o Nanumea. E lua mai ai ko te ano mo te fātele, kolā koa fai mo iloga e lavea i ai a te fakatāua o pō fakamanatu kolā e fai e te fenua i loto i te tauhaga kātoa...

E tokouke a tāgata mo fāfine e mafai o lavea a olotou loto kau fakatahi mai olotou lava 'gali ni fakatoka, telā koa fai mo togiga o te pō, fakatahi mo olotou lākei 'gali mo teuteuga ake e uke. Kae ko te tafiti e fakaali mai e ia ki tino a te auala tauga tonu telā e fakatalitonugina i ai a te olotou mālosi, mo te tūlaga o te tinā tagata tonu.

Chapter 14 | Island Games and Entertainments

This chapter describes some games and recreational activities that have delighted generations of Nanumean people. Two of these, namely ano and fātele, form the heart of festive celebrations enjoyed by the community throughout the year...

Many men and women eagerly participate in these, wearing specially prepared clothing that serves as the day's uniform and also beautiful wreaths and other decorations. Tafito (wrestling) gives men an acceptable way to demonstrate their strength and masculinity. Children have long enjoyed playing their own traditional games near their homes in the village, on the beach, and in the calm water of the lagoon as well.

Ano

A te ano he igoa o te tāhaoga, kae ko pōlo e lua kolā e fakaaogā ki te ano (te tāhaoga) e fakaiogo hoki ki te ano. A te tāhaoga tenei, e tā'hao i matakau e lua. E hēai he gatāga o te tokouke. E 'tū katoa i loto o vaka e lua kolā koa oti ni māka faka'pau i te 'lahi (kāti e 20x8mita).

I te gāloto o vaka e lua e toe māka hoki a te laina i ai e noho pelā ki te 5-6 mita ki te mata ki mua o te vaka (kaulama). Ko lāua kolā e 'pā a te ano e igoa ko te alovaka mo tona fakatū. A te alovaka ko ia telā e 'pā a te ano ke tō ki loto i te vaka o te faitu e tahi, kae ko te fakatū ko ia e uhu a te ano ke 'pā e te alovaka.

A te agaga o te tāhaoga tenei e tai 'pau ailoa mo te uoli-pōlo. E taumafai a te alovaka ke tō a te ano, kae ko tino i te faitu e tahi, e taumafai ke hē tō a te ano. A te kai e tau manafai e tō a te ano.

A kai e tau penei:

- A te ulu e tahi, e sefulu a kai i ai, kae ko te lelemutu e lima a kai.
- Kae ko te afe e tahi, e lima a ulu i loto, kae ko te lelemutu e tolu a ulu;
- Kae fai e tahi a te afe, koa tahi a te mālō. Telā koa mafai o uhu he olotou fātele fakapāau.
- Oti i ai koa toe 'fuli, ko te matākau lā telā e mālō, koa toe fai hoki he olotou fātele fakapāau.

Kae fai ko tāgata ni ano i te taimi nei, ko malōlo nei a tāgata, kae koa 'tū ake a fāfine, fakaholo

Ano

Ano is the name of a game as well the name of the balls that are used to play it. The game is played with two teams, with no limitation on the number of players. All players stand in the two rectangular areas (vaka) marked out to be equal in size, each about 20x8 meters.

Separating the two vaka is a dividing line that is 5 or 6 meters in front of the first row of players (kaulama) in each vaka. The two players who serve the ano are named alovaka ('canoe paddler'), the one who hurls the ball, and fakatū ('make to stand up'), his setter-upper.

The spirit of this game is very similar to volleyball. Each alovaka tries to make the ball hit the ground on the other side, while players on each team try to prevent that. A point is earned when the opposing team's ball touches the ground.

The score is kept as follows:

- One ulu contains 10 points, while the lelemutu (half score) has 5 points.
- The afe contains 5 ulu but if one side has scored 3 ulu to 0, then that is also a full (though shorter) game, called a lelemutu.
- When the game is won with an afe score, the winning team can perform a mocking fātele dance.
- The teams then change sides of the playing field, and the side that wins makes a mocking fātele.

If the men have played first, they then take a break and the women have their turn,

ailoa penā ke oko ki te lima ia me ko te ono i te afiafi.

I taimi o pō 'lahi, e kāmata mai i te Kilisimasi ko te ano ailoa koa 'hoko atu ke tū mālō ki te Pō o Tefolaha. Kae fai ailoa e tūmau a te 'gali o tāhaoga, e mafai a tamatāne/tamāfine o toe fakatagi ke toe tolo atu a tāhaoga. Telā i taimi e oko ailoa ki a Fepuali a te faiga o tāhaoga.

A te gali o te tāhaoga tenei ko te ano, e pogai ki te 'lei o alovaka, kae mailoga ailoa ko te fakatū, telā ke mafai e ia o āgoi a te ano ki mō mea kolā e loto ki ai a te alovaka...

continuing on in this way until 5 or 6 in the evening.

The regular Big Days celebration begins at Christmas and continues until the Day of Tefolaha in early January. After that, however, at the end of each day's play, the young men and women and players can request the village elders to keep on extending the games, day by day.

The good spirit of the ano games depends upon the skill of the alovaka, but also especially on his fakatū to put the ball exactly where the alovaka wants it. When the alovaka tells his setter to send it to the back, the ano ball flies up high, reaching all the way to players at the back of the vaka...

Tafiti

A te tafiti, he tāhaoga e tahi e māhāni ki ai a tāgata Nanumea i pō mua. E māhāni o fai tele i taimi o kau māhina, mai tai o hikiga o vaka. E māhāni o kāmata tele e tama'liki fo'liki.

E 'vae ki putukau e lua. Kae fai koa kāmata, e kalaga ake he tamaliki tai lahi penei, 'A tatou koa kāmata..kae kāmata i mone.' (A mōne ko tamaliki tagata fo'liki.) Ko te mea ailoa koa fakaholo ke oko ailoa ki te tupulaga pelā koa taki 15-16/tauhaga.

E fai tele ailoa penā i taimi o kau mahina katoa. Haumaefa mo Lolua e māhāni tele hoki o fai a te laga tafiti i te pō.

Wrestling

Wrestling was an entertainment that most young Nanumean men took part in in the past. It was usually done by the light of the full moon on the lagoon shore, near where the canoes were beached.

The wrestling began with the mone, small boys (about 8 years old), divided into two groups. When it was time to start, an older boy would call out, 'We are going to start!' The matches began with the smaller boys and then, one by one, continued up to those aged 15 to 16 years old.

This entertainment was usually done every moonlit night. Both Haumaefa and Lolua communities regularly organised wrestling sessions at night.

Fātele

A te fātele e tō i loto i te itukaiga o mea konei ko pehe. Telā he fakatokaga o muna, fai a tona lau, fakatahi mo tona hākaga koa avake i ai ke oko ki tino e tokouke, koa maua i ai a te mea tenei ko te fātele. Ko tona uiga e tahi, he maopoopoga o tino kolā e uhu kae 'mako.

A te fātele e gali manafai e kātōa a mea konei:

- Ke tokouke a tino i loto i te kaufātele, kae ke pā kae ke 'lau katoa
- E manakogina ni tino 'lei i loto i te pokesi, mo he tino leo 'lei kae koa oti ni akoako faka'lei i te uhu fātele
- He tino māhāni i te kini kāpa

Fātele (Dance)

Fātele falls within the category of things called pehe (songs). A composition of words set to music, with its accompanying dance spread outward to reach many people, produces what is called fātele. In its simplest meaning, it is a gathering of people who sing and dance.

A fātele is beautiful when all of the following are present:

- There are many people in the kaufātele, all singing and clapping
- There are attractive people in the front row, and a good singer who has been well trained in the art of singing fātele
- A person skilled in kini kāpa (a percussion instrument)

- A tino 'mako ke 'mau faka'lei i haka o fātele, kae ke 'toka hoki mo olotou titi, mo olotou manogi
- Ke iai he takitaki o te fātele
- The dancers hold the fātele movements correctly, and are adorned with their titi skirts and fragrant garlands
- There is a leader of the fātele

Tāhaoga a Tamaliki

A tāhaoga konei mai lalo e tā'hao tele i ai a tamaliki, tamatāne mo tamāfine tai foliki. I te tulaga telā e fakafiafia ki ai a lātou, kae e hē tokouke a tino tā'hao i tāhaoga kōnei. A fakamatalaga mai lalo nei e fakāli mai i ai a te lahi o te hekehekega o tāhaoga faka te fenua.

Aiō

Fafanua

Fakataua-moa

Fakatūpou

Fū-ikonā / Fū-ikonei

Fū-penu

Fū-tama

Kāpeni

Children's Games

These games are commonly played by children and by younger men and women. Usually they are just played casually, often by only a small number of players. The following descriptions show the great variety of these traditional games and the creativity inherent in their design.

Aiō – A hide-and-seek game played by moonlight in the village and on the beach. Girls go to sleep early, but boys continue playing.

Fafanua – Two teams of boys (12–14 years), about ten per side. Two canoe-shaped areas 15 metres apart, with a 'jail' marked at the front. First tagged goes to jail; team that tags all opponents wins.

Fakataua-moa (Cock-fighting) – Boys aged 8–12 tie a rooster's leg with a short cord in an open area and set their roosters to fight. If their rooster loses they fetch another. If it wins, a fine may be imposed by the island policeman.

Fakatūpou – Boys aged 14–16 in teams of five. One stands upright; the others bow forward holding the waist of the person ahead. The opposite team leaps onto their backs one by one trying not to collapse the 'human chain.'

Fū-ikonā / Fū-ikonei – Two teams of children 8–10. Each team scatters and writes (marks) hiding spots in the sand. The cry 'Fū i konā, Fū i konei!' starts the rush to erase the opponent's marks. Team with most marks remaining wins.

Fū-penu – A person circles others seated on the ground holding a dried, stiffened mat strip (penu) behind their back. They try to secretly place it behind one person and chase that person before they realise.

Fū-tama – Played outside the sleeping house by moonlight. One group sits; another hides behind a mat, then approaches and asks 'How many are we?' If the seated group guesses correctly, the hidden group sits down. Boys and girls can both play.

Kāpeni – Played by girls aged 14–16 in two teams. Similar to baseball but the ball is struck

with the palm. Four bases are marked in the sand; three outs and the teams switch. Five innings = victory.

Lafo

Lafo – Four players throw a smooth, compressed pandanus leaf disc across spread-out mats. Points scored for landing closest to the target mat. Play up to ten rounds.

Pōili

Pōili – Best with about 20 players in a tight circle. One person stands in the middle (the 'tufa'). A light ball is kicked and kneed around; players try not to let it touch the ground.

Sākaika

Sākaika – A stick is planted in the ground as a 'base.' One child guards it; the rest try to reach the base before being tagged. Whoever is tagged first becomes the new guard.

Sinamatāi

Sinamatāi – Two teams of boys 14–16. One team calls out a chant and hides; the other searches. When found they swap roles. (Note: the chant appears to be of Samoan origin.)

Tā (String Figures)

Tā (String Figures) – Using a loop of cord to create figures with names such as: Fakapalega o te Aliki, Kakega o Iakopo, Tā ki gutu, Mata pekipeki, Hele pāla, etc.

Tapokopoko

Tapokopoko – Girls aged 7–13 play in pairs. One tries to kick her own heels while jumping (tapokopoko). If her feet don't connect cleanly she loses to her partner.

Teka

Teka – A flat, rounded coral disc (4 inches wide, 1 inch thick) is wrapped in pandanus leaf and skimmed along the ground. The player whose disc travels furthest wins.

Tihoa

Tihoa – Played in the lagoon shallows (6–8 feet deep). One player stands in a shallow spot holding 15–20 cowrie shells, one marked as the 'king.' They are thrown in; players dive to retrieve them. Whoever finds the king-shell becomes the next thrower.

Titī me Fakamāofa

Titī me Fakamāofa – Girls' version of Jacks. Uses katapule (small stones or fetau seeds) and a ball. Progressive rounds: pick up 1, then 2, then 3... at 4 you clap all four to the floor before catching. First to reach 'forehead' wins.

Titī Matalau

Titī Matalau – Juggling with 2 or 3 balls (2 balls = one hand; 3 balls = two hands). Played in pairs. First to drop loses.

Tika

Tika – Five or more boys shape a kaukini (reed) into a dart 3–4 feet long. On smooth flat ground they line up and launch their darts underarm to

skim the surface. Best distance wins; darts can travel 50+ metres.

Tupaloaloa

Tupaloaloa – Girls aged 10–15 join hands in a ring. One stands in the middle trying to break through. Whoever let her through becomes the next person in the middle.

Uku Fala

Uku Fala – A bundle of pandanus leaves tied to a rope, hung from a tree near the lagoon. Players dive down repeatedly, tearing off one leaf per dive. The person with the most breath (most leaves torn off) wins.

Utu

Utu – Pairs of girls, similar to Tapokopoko but both feet are used simultaneously. If your heels fail to connect first, you lose.

Tāhaoga e mafai o fakaopopo

- utuao
- fakatulioma
- fakataua matau
- pu manu
- tue
- tāhaoga ki gutu – faka pakē
- toy sailing canoes, rafts
- rock, scissors, paper type of game
- clapping or rhyming games
- windmill made of launiu

Games to be added

- utuao
- fakatulioma
- fakataua matau
- pu manu
- tue
- tāhaoga ki gutu – faka pakē
- toy sailing canoes, rafts
- rock, scissors, paper type of game
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